[METRIC]

A-A-2785
July 21, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PENCIL, DRAFTING

This Commercial Item Description is approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

This commercial item description covers wood cased lead drafting pencils for use as a marking medium on paper and intended for fine line writing and for use by accountants, statisticians, draftsman and artists.

I. Salient characteristics.

A. Pencils shall be wood cased with black lead. The casing shall be round or hexagonal finished with bright colored lacquer. The length of the pencil shall be not less than 16.98 cm (6 11/16 inches) not including eraser in conformance with section IIB.

B. The eraser shall be in accordance with the latest revision of Commercial Item Description A-A-132.

C. Pencils shall produce uniformly dense, dark, opaque marks when used on paper. Marks shall be smudge resistant, shall reproduce clearly and shall erase cleanly without ghosting when using a pencil type rubber eraser, artgum eraser or plastic film eraser.

D. Leads shall be continuously smooth marking, and shall not crumble or chip, and shall be of such strength and resilience so as to reduce breakage when used properly.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7510

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E. The hardness of the pencil leads shall be as follows:

The hardness range shall be expressed as a "grade" as defined by ASTM C709 and be one of the following, as specified (See section VIII - Notes):

10H, 9H, 8H, 7H, 6H, 5H, 4H, 3H, 2H, H, HB, B, 1B, 2B, 3B, 4B, 5B, 6B, 7B, 8B, 9B, 10B

The hardness of the pencil leads shall be such that no inversion shall take place as the density transits from 10 H to 10 B for the pencils of the same brand. The grades and lack of inversions shall be certified by the vendor to be in conformance with normal commercial practice. The evidence of this conformance shall be available to the government in the form of a chart of line densities for the full range of grades, upon request.

F. Diameter shall be in conformance with normal commercial practice and uniform throughout the entire length of the lead (see section IIA).

G. Lead shall be centered within the casing and securely bonded (glued) to the casing throughout the entire length. Lead shall be continuously smooth marking, provide clearly visible lines, not crumble or dust.

H. The wood casing shall be straight, the two halves securely bonded (glued) throughout the entire length of the pencil and in conformance with normal commercial practice.

I. When sharpened the wood casing shall not split, splinter or tear, shall present a smooth finish, and the lead shall not crumble or break.

J. Pencils shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark, hardness, and other normal commercial markings shall be acceptable.

K. The color of the case shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

L. When used for purpose intended, pencils will pass the performance test (See section II C).

M. Toxicity. In the leads, no raw material that has ingredients of harmful substances shall be used, and the contents of lead, cadmium and arsenic shall be 200 ppm or less, respectively. As an alternative to the to the above the Pencil Manufacturers Association Toxicity Certification is acceptable (see section VII). The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed Std. 313.

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N. Workmanship. Pencils shall be free from splits, splinter, blisters and any other imperfections which affect the appearance or might impair usage.

II. Tests & Measurements.

A. Diameter. Measurements shall be taken at three points (near each end, and the middle) of each specimen. The mean of the three measurements shall determine the conformance of the specimen.

B. Length. Measurements shall be made once per each specimen selected, using a device with precision of at least 2 mm.

C. Performance Test. Each sample shall be sharpened and tested by drawing a line 50 cm under ordinary writing pressures. The lines shall show uniformity of color and evenness as required by this specification. When drawing a line, the lead shall work smoothly without grittiness on bond paper.

III. Regulatory requirements. The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

IV. Hazardous material requirements.

A. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

B. Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see VIII), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Lot definition. Each lot of pencils shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall be expressed in pencils manufactured from the same materials, at essentially the same time.

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C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph
Appearance	Not as specified
Material	Not as specified
Casing	Not glued together
Eraser	Loose and not as specified.

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

The examination for the characteristics listed in the following table will be based on the specifications/requirements listed in NOTES (see section (see VIII) for the specific pencil being examined.

Examine	Defects
Hardness	Not as specified
Length	Not as specified
Diameter	Not as specified

E. Tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one pencil.

Examine	Defects
Performance Test	Does not comply

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

VI. Preparation for delivery.

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII). The normal commercial number of unit

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packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

3. Additional marking. The shipping containers shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

VII. Applicable documents.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. American Society for Testing Materials (ASTM):

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

C 709 Standard definitions of terms relating to manufactured carbon and graphite.

B. Pencil Manufacturers Association (PMA):

PMA standards and certifications are available from the Pencil Manufacturers Association, Two Greentree Center Suite 225, PO. Box 955, Marlton NJ 08053.

Pencil Manufacturers Association Toxicity Certification.

C. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:
Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

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Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials
16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

D. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., 2200 Mil Rd., Alexandria, VA 22314.

National Motor Freight Classification

E. Uniform Classification Committee Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Railroad Freight Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification

F. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:
Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and GSA Specification Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D streets SW., Washington, D.C. 20407.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

G. Military Standards:
Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk; Bldg. 4D; 700 Robbins Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

VIII. Notes.

Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(b) Purchasers shall specify the pencil grade.

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(c) Purchasers shall specify if an eraser is required.
(d) Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified (see tests and quality assurance requirements.)
(e) Purchasers shall specify packaging and packing, any special marking for shipment required, if other than required (see preparation for delivery).
(f) Identification marking, if other than required.
(g) If bar code marking is not required.
(h) MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
(i) Purchasers shall specify palletization , if required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

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